

ANNA CAPRINALI

Early Career Researcher

7 December 1997

Italian nationality

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am an Early Career Researcher interested in LGB(TQIA+) inequalities and the social and psychological processes driving minority stress and social exclusion at the intersection of demography and social stratification.

I earned my PhD in March 2026 with a dissertation on educational inequalities among LGB adolescents. Recently, I joined the SOLO project, studying the interrelations of living alone, loneliness, and social isolation in UK young adults.

The social relationship dynamics central to my previous work are also primary psychological mechanisms driving loneliness and social isolation across the life course, motivating my future research to investigate how gender, sexual orientation, and parental relationships intersect to produce inequalities across these dimensions.

WORK and RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Apr 2026 - ongoing

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, University of Padua

Fellowship in the project *Traiettorie di Isolamento (vivere da soli, solitudine, isolamento sociale) e Salute nel Corso di Vita*

Responsibilities: contributing to conceptual development, statistical analyses, and co-authoring an initial manuscript for the SOLO project, examining the interrelationships between living alone, loneliness, and social isolation.

May - July 2024

Research Fellow, University of Trento

Collaboration in the project “ALFA - Aligning Law with Family Arrangements: Non-traditional Families’ Contribution to Addressing Italy’s Demographic Crisis.”

Responsibilities: combining data from different data sources, statistical analysis of data, producing descriptive results and graphs for the report, drafting of a paper.

Dec 2021 - Jan 2022

External project evaluator, Centro Studi Cultura Sviluppo (CSCS)

Evaluation of an Erasmus+ KA2 Strategic Partnership project in a team of three researchers. We assessed the project’s objectives, outcomes, and impact according to Erasmus+ criteria.

Responsibilities: desk review, qualitative interviews, questionnaire construction and final report writing.

- Sept - Oct 2021* **Research Fellow, University of Trento**
Contributed to the first Gender Balance institutional report.
Responsibilities: statistical analysis of university data, producing tables and graphs for publication.
- Sept 2018 - Sept 2019* **Student Assistant, Centro Studi interdisciplinari di Genere (CSG) - University of Trento**
Extracurricular internship supporting research projects.
Responsibilities: collection of archival data, transcription of interviews, quantitative analysis, creation of dissemination materials, conference organization and administrative tasks.

EDUCATION

- Nov 2021 - Mar 2026* **PhD in Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento**
Focus: LGBTQIA* demography, Social stratification.
Language: English
Thesis: “Diverging trajectories? Educational stratification and life opportunities of LGB adolescents”.
Supervisor: Prof. Agnese Vitali.
- May 2023 - Jul 2023* **PhD Visiting, Centre d’Estudis Demogràfics (CED)**
Tutor: Dr. Diederik Boertien
- Sept 2020 - Jan 2022* **MA Sociology & Demography, Universitat Pompeu Fabra**
Double Degree program with University of Trento
Focus: Quantitative research methods, Demography.
Language: English
Thesis: “The transition from cohabitation to marriage in Spain: differences and determinants in same-sex and different-sex couples”.
Supervisors: Prof. Clara Cortina, Prof. Agnese Vitali.
- Sept 2019 - Sept 2021* **MA Sociology & Social Research, University of Trento**
Double Degree program with Universitat Pompeu Fabra
Focus: Quantitative & Qualitative methods, Sociology.
Language: English
- Sept 2016 - Sept 2019* **BA Sociology, University of Trento**
Focus: Sociological Theory, Quantitative research.
Thesis: “Pink collar works: the persistence of horizontal segregation”.
Language: Italian
Supervisor: Prof. Barbara Poggio.

SCHOOLS AND SEMINARS

- 8th - 9th May 2025 “Age-Period-Cohort (APC) Analysis. Old Controversies and New Solutions”
University of Trento
- 4th - 6th July 2022 “Causal Inference” - RECSM summer methods school
Universitat Pompeu Fabra - online
- 20th - 24th June 2022 “COORDINATE Summer School on Longitudinal Analysis of Child and Adolescent Data Featuring UKHLS”
ISER, University of Essex
- 4th - 6th May 2022 “Introduction to Event History Analysis”
GESIS, Mannheim - online

PUBLICATIONS

- Caprinali, A. & Vitali, A. (2026). Educational Outcomes of UK LGB and Heterosexual Adolescents: Exploring Gendered Differences and Mechanisms. *European Sociological Review*, 42(2), 301-321. <https://doi.org/10.1093/esr/jcaf045>
- Baams, L., Caprinali, A., & Fischer, M. (2025). Navigating time: A systematic review of the timing of sexual and gender identity milestones. In: Baams, L. Kaufman T. M. L., *Sexually and Gender Diverse Adolescents. Critical Perspectives on Risk and Resilience*. Routledge. <http://dx.doi.org/10.4324/9781003479055-17>
- Caprinali, A. & Vitali, A. (2025). The demography of sexual identity development and disclosure among LGB people in Europe. *Demographic Research*, 52(5), 125-140. <https://doi.org/10.4054/DemRes.2025.52.5>
- Caprinali, A., Vitali, A., & Cortina, C. (2023). The transition from cohabitation to marriage in Spain: differences and determinants in same-sex and different-sex couples. *Genus*, 79(1), 24. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41118-023-00201-0>
- (Under review) Caprinali, A. & Boertien, D., LGB Students’ Educational Premium in Context: Mechanisms and Change across Two UK Birth Cohorts
- (Finalising for submission) Caprinali, A., Partnership Disparities between UK LGB and Heterosexual Adults: Chances and Educational Gradients

DISSEMINATION PIECES

- Chiariotti F., Agostini A., Caprinali, A., Ferraretto V. & Saggese F., “Psicopatologia del Dottorato di Ricerca. Le condizioni di lavoro e la salute mentale nell’ambito del dottorato di ricerca.” (“Psychopathology of Doctoral Programs. Working conditions and mental health in doctoral programs.”). January 2024. [Link to the report](#) (Last access: 23/12/2025)
- Caprinali, A. & Vitali, A., “Non è troppo presto. La scoperta dell’orientamento sessuale e

il ruolo della scuola in adolescenza” (“It’s not too early. The discovery of sexual orientation and the role of school in adolescence”). 7 March 2023, Neodemos.info. [Link to Neodemos.info](#) (Last access: 10/01/2026)

Caprinali, A., De Preto, L., & Tuselli, A., “Le parole per includere: glossario LGBTQI+ Uni-Trento” (“Words for inclusion: LGBTQI+ glossary UniTrento”). *Equità Diversità - UniTn*. [Link to the glossary](#) (Last access: 10/01/2026)

HONOURS & AWARDS

Best Poster at one of the Poster Sessions - EPC 2026

European Association of Population Studies (EAPS)

6th June 2026

AISP-Genus Early Career Award

Italian Association of Population Studies (AISP)

29th March 2023

Collegio Clesio membership diploma - B.A & M.A. level

Collegio Clesio - University of Trento

September 2019 & September 2021

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS PRESENTATIONS

(Forthcoming) EPC 2026 - European Population Conference, Bologna

3rd June - 6th June 2026

Workshop INED-CED, Barcelona

“Family and Work Among LGBTs at the Crossroad of Demography and Sociology”

9th September - 10th September 2025

BSPS Annual Conference 2025, Swansea

2nd September - 4th September 2025

5th ISA Forum of Sociology 2025, Rabat

6th - 11th July 2025

Giornate di Studio sulla Popolazione - Popdays 2025, Cagliari

4th June - 6th June 2025

RC28 Spring Meeting 2025, Milan

25th May - 27th May 2025

Sixth Joint Doctoral Conference, Trento

28th November - 29th November 2024

ECSR 2024 - European Consortium for Sociological Research, Barcelona

12th September - 14th September 2024

EPC 2024 - European Population Conference, Edinburgh

12th June - 15th June 2024

Workshop LGBTQ+, Utrecht

“LGBTQ+: Attitudes in the general population and self-identification”

21st - 22nd November 2023

PAA 2023 - Population Association of America’s annual meeting, New Orleans

12th - 15th April 2023

Giornate di Studio sulla Popolazione - Popdays 2023, Rome

1st - 3rd February 2023

Gender R-Evolutions. Convegno Nazionale CSG 2022, Trento

25th - 26th November 2022

EPC 2022 - European Population Conference, Groningen

29th June - 2nd July 2022

TEACHING ACTIVITY

25th Nov 2025

Guest Lecturer (2h), University of Trento

Sociology and Social Research, M.A. degree

Course: Social Demography

Lecture: Queer demography: Emerging evidence on the LGBTQ+ population

25th Sept 2025

Guest Lecturer (2h), University of Trento

Master in Social Foresight

Lecture: Introduzione alla demografia. “Nuove” dinamiche demografiche (*Introduction to Demography. “New” Demographic Dynamics*)

20th & 27th Nov 2024

Guest Lecturer - Laboratory (4h), University of Trento

Sociology and Social Research, M.A. degree

Course: Social Demography

Lecture: Event History Analysis - Theory and Application

Feb - May 2024

Teaching Assistant - Laboratory (24h), University of Trento

Sociology, B.A. degree

Course: Metodi e tecniche della ricerca sociale (*Methods and Techniques for Social Research*)

Sept - Dec 2023

Teaching Assistant - Laboratory (24h), University of Trento

Sociology, B.A. degree

Course: Metodi quantitativi per la ricerca (*Quantitative Methods for Research*)

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Conference Organization (scientific and organizational committee)

“Sixth Joint Doctoral Conference”, 28th - 29th November 2024

<https://www.unitn.it/en/sixth-joint-doctoral-conference-2024-trento>

Reviewer

Demographic Research, Advances in Life Course Research, European Journal of Population

PhD Representative in Department Council

University of Trento (2022-2024)

Member of the ADI National Study Service

Associazione Dottorandi Italiani (ADI), 2021-2024

Task: Survey design and data analysis on the working conditions of PhDs in Italy.

Member of the ADI National Directive

Associazione Dottorandi Italiani (ADI), 2026-ongoing

METHODOLOGICAL & DIGITAL SKILLS

Extensive knowledge: Quantitative research methods and visualization.

Programs: STATA, Microsoft Office, Google Suite.

Moderate knowledge: Survey design and administration.

Programs: R, Atlas.ti, LimeSurvey, LaTeX.

Basic knowledge: Qualitative research methods, Programming.

Programs: Python, HTML, NVivo.

LANGUAGES

	Reading	Listening	Writing	Speaking
English	C2	C2	C1	C1
Spanish	A2	A2	A1	A1
Italian	Native	Native	Native	Native

OTHER RELEVANT SKILLS

Strong propensity to teamwork and team research projects

Leadership, advocacy, and communication skills enhanced through my experience as PhD representative and active member of ADI (at both local and national level)

Organizational and planning skills gained through internships and further enhanced during the organisation of the “Sixth Joint Doctoral Conference”.